

Herbs that Warm the Interior and Expel Cold

- Warm the interior and dispel cold.
- Acrid, warm, hot, and dry.
- Dispel cold and restore internal warmth.
- Excess cold attacking the interior or yang deficiency.
- Differentiate conditions and combine different herbs
- Caution: Yin and fluid deficiency, internal heat, and during pregnancy.

Name	Similarities	Differences
Fu Zi (<i>Radix Aconiti Lateralis Praeparata</i>)	Warm interior, disperse cold and relieve pain	Warms body yang, restores devastated yang, augments ming men (life gate) fire, warms the channels
Gan Jiang (<i>Rhizoma Zingiberis</i>)		Warms Spleen and Lung, restores devastated Yang. Pao Jiang stops bleeding.
Rou Gui (<i>Cortex Cinnamomi</i>)		Warms Kidney yang, augments ming men fire, warms channels, promotes the generation of flesh
Wu Zhu Yu (<i>Fructus Evodiae</i>)	Warm the middle jiāo, disperse cold, and relieve pain	Relieves Liver qi constraint, alleviates headache and hernial pain, redirects rebellious qi downward
Gao Liang Jiang (<i>Rhizoma Alpiniae Officinarum</i>)		Treats abdominal pain/hernial pain, intestinal cramps, and diarrhea due to cold
Hua Jiāo (<i>Pericarpium Zanthoxyli</i>)		Treats vomiting and diarrhea due to cold; kills parasites, and relieves toothache
Ding Xiang (<i>Flos Caryophylli</i>)		Epigastric and abd. pain due to abnormal rising of Stomach qi caused by coldness; warms and assists Kidney yang.
Hu Jiāo (<i>Fructus Piper</i>)		Treat nausea, vomiting, and gastrointestinal symptoms due to cold
Bì Bā (<i>Fructus Piperis Longi</i>)		Treats nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea due to deficiency cold
Xiao Hui Xiang (<i>Fructus Foeniculi</i>)		It dispels cold from the Liver and kidney channels to treat hernial disorders. Regulates qi and improves appetite
Xi Xin (<i>Herba Asari</i>)		Dispels wind-cold, dissolves phlegm

Fù Zǐ 附子 “appendage”

- ☯ *Radix Aconiti Lateralis praeparata*
- ☯ **English:** aconite, prepared daughter root of common monk's
- ☯ **Properties:** acrid, **hot, toxic**
- ☯ **Channels:** Heart, Kidney, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Restores devastated Yang

Indications – for devastated yang disorders where the yang qi is extremely weak and the cold yin is abundant.

Gan Jiang, Gan Cao (si ni tang), Ren Shen (shen fu tang)

Actions: Augments fire and assists the Yang (Ht, Sp, K)

Indications – for any problem associated with weakness or deficiency of the Heart, Spleen or Kidney Yang.

- ☯ Kidney yang deficiency, Kidney fire failure
Rou Gui, Shu Di Huang, Shan Zhu Yu (gui fu ba wei wan)
- ☯ Spleen yang deficiency
Ren Shen, Bai Zhu, Gan Jiang (fu zi li zhong wan)
- ☯ Spleen and Kidney yang deficiency
Bai Zhu, Fu Ling (zhen wu tang)
- ☯ Heart yang deficiency
Ren Shen, Gui Zhi
- ☯ Spontaneous sweating due to yang deficiency
Huang Qi, Gui Zhi
- ☯ Exterior wind-cold with internal yang deficiency
Ma Huang, Xi Xin

Actions: *Fu Zi* warms entire body yang. It treats any type of yang deficiency, as it warms all of the organs and opens all of the channels and collaterals.

Actions: Disperses cold-dampness, warms the channels and alleviates pain

Indications – for wind-damp-cold painful obstruction, especially when cold is predominant

Main Actions

- Revives the yang and restores devastated yang
- Augments fire and assists the Yang
- Disperses cold-dampness, warms the channels and alleviates pain

Dosage: 3-15 grams.

Fu Zi must be pre-decocted for 30 to 60 minutes.

When prescribing *Fu Zi*, the condition of the individual must be taken into consideration.

Cautions

- *Fu Zi* is contraindicated during pregnancy.
- It is contraindicated in patients with yang excess and yin deficiency (also referred to as false cold and true heat).
- *Fu Zi* is incompatible with *Bei Mu*, *Ban Xia*, *Gua Lou Shi*, *Bai Ji*, and *Bai Lian*.
- Consumption of alcohol is contraindicated with *Fu Zi*, as absorption of the toxic elements will be significantly enhanced.

NOTES:

Over dosage

Side effects and adverse reactions are usually due to overdose.

Signs and symptoms: involuntary salivation, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, dizziness, blurred vision, dry mouth, vertigo, numbness of the body and extremities, slowed pulse, difficulty breathing, twitching limbs, convulsions, disorientation, urinary and fecal incontinence, decreased pressure and body temperature, arrhythmia, and possible death.

Treatment of overdose

1. *Rou Gui* is usually used to reverse early-stage overdose within 4 to 6 hours of the ingestion of *Fu Zi*. *Rou Gui* tea was prepared by soaking 5 to 10 grams of the herbs in hot water. The tea should induce vomiting of the toxin within 5 to 15 minutes, and relieve overall symptoms within 15 to 30 minutes.

2. Overdose of *Fu Zi* can also be treated with a decoction containing *Sheng Jiang*, *Gan Jiang*, *Lu Dou*, *Hei Dou*, *Huang Lian*, *Ren Shen*, and *Huang Qi*

Herb-drug interaction

Patients who have a history of cardiovascular disorders or are taking antiarrhythmic medications should take *Fu Zi* with extreme caution.

Review questions

- What are the properties and cautions of interior-warming herbs?
- Actions and Indications of *Fu Zi*.
- *Fu Zi* warms the Yang of which organs?
- Herb that restores devastated Yang.
- Herbs for treating wind-damp-cold Bi syndrome.
- How is *Fu Zi* prepared when making a decoction?

Gān Jiāng 干姜
“dry ginger”

- *Rhizoma Zingiberis Officinalis*
- **English:** dried ginger rhizome
- **Properties:** acrid, **hot**
- **Channels:** Spleen, Stomach, Heart, Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle Jiāo and expels cold:

Indications – for warming the Spleen and Stomach in conditions of excess due to wind, cold, and in deficiency due to insufficient yang qi

Gan Jiang can be used alone as powder for external cold attacking the interior.

Nausea due cold in the Stomach

Gan Jiang + Ban Xia (ban xia gan jiang san)

Deficient cold due to Sp and St. yang deficiency

Ren Shen, Bai Zhu, Gan Cao (Li Zhong Tang)

Actions: Restores devastated Yang and expels interior cold:

Indications – for devastated Yang with such signs as a very weak pulse and cold limbs.

Actions: Warms the Lungs and transforms phlegm:

Indications – for Lung cold with expectoration of thin, watery, or white sputum.

Ma Huang, Xi Xin, Wu Wei Zi (xiao qing long tang)

Pào Jiāng 炮姜

“Charred Gan Jiang”

- **Properties:** bitter, astringent, and warm
- **Actions:** warms channels and stops bleeding
- **Channels:** Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the channels and stops bleeding

Indications – for deficiency cold that may present with hemorrhage of various types, especially uterine bleeding. Also for diarrhea due to deficient cold.

(Back to) Gan Jiang 干姜

Main Actions:

- Warms the middle Jiāo

- Restores devastated yang
- Warms the Lung and transforms phlegm

Dosage: 3-10 grams

Cautions:

Gan Jiang is contraindicated in cases of interior heat with yin deficiency or heat in the blood.

Use with caution during pregnancy. Large doses can cause abortion.

Gan Jiang 干姜 Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Gan Jiang.
- What herbs restore devastated Yang, and how do they work together?
- Comparison of Fu Zi and Gan Jiang
- Comparison of Gan Jiang and Pao Jiang
- Comparison of Sheng Jiang and Gan Jiang
- Actions and main indication of Pao Jiāo

Ròu Guì 肉桂

- *Cortex Cinnamomi Cassiae*
- **English:** inner bark of Saigon cinnamon
- **Properties:** acrid, sweet, **hot**
- **Channels:** Heart, Kidney, Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the Kidney yang and augments Ming Men fire

Indications – treat a wide variety of disorders characterized by Kidney yang deficiency and insufficient *ming men* fire, such as intolerance to cold, cold extremities, weakness, soreness and coldness of the lower back and knees, impotence, polyuria, and loose stools.

- Rou Gui is acrid and hot; it is a pure yang herb, it warms up and tonifies ming men fire, raising the Yang to overcome the yin (cold). It is “Yao Yao” for treating lower jiāo deficient cold due to Yuan yang deficiency.
- Kidney yang/ming men fire deficiency: Fu Zi, Shu Di Huang, Shan Zhu Yu
- Spleen and Kidney yang deficiency: Fu Zi, Gang Jiang, Bai Zhu
- Yang floating up with lower jiāo yang deficiency leading to warm above and cold below, Rou Gui can guide floating Yang back to the Kidney. (Formula: Yin Huo Gui yuan)

Actions: Dispels cold, relieves pain, opens channels and vessels

Indications: abdominal pain with cold sensation, cold-damp Bi syndromes, lower back pain, and blood stagnation due to cold in the blood. It can be taken individually in powder form. + *Dang Gui*, *Chuan Ziong*

Yin sores:

- Rou Gui warms the channels and collaterals to treat deep-rooted sores. It promotes tissue generation and enhances recovery. + *Shu Di Huang*, *Lu Jiāo Jiao*, *Ma Huang*
- Sores with pus but not ulceration: + *Huang Qi*, *Dang Gui*
- Adding a small quantity of Rou Gui to qi and blood tonics will enhance the movement of yang qi in the body and encourage the production of qi and blood. Formula: *Ren shen yang ying tang*, *Si quan da bu tang*

Main Actions

- Warms the Kidney yang and augments the Ming Men fire
- Disperses cold and alleviates pain
- Warms channels and vessels

Dosage:

2 to 5 grams in herbal decoction, 1 to 2 grams in powder form.

Rou Gui should be added in the last 5 to 10 minutes of cooking to prevent loss of active constituents due to overexposure to heat.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Rou Gui
- How does Rou Gui tonify Kidney yang and Ming Men fire to treat lower jiao deficient cold?
- Herb for treating cold congealing with qi or blood stagnation.
- How can Rou Gui encourage the production of qi and blood?
- What is the herb for treating Yin-type sores?
- How is Rou Gui prepared in decoction?

Wú Zhū Yú 吴茱萸

“Wu-Zhu’s fruit” “evodia of Wu”

Fructus Evodiae Rutaecarpae

English: Evodia fruit

Properties: acrid, bitter, **hot, slightly toxic**

Channels: Kidney, Liver, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle, disperses cold, relieves constraint in the Liver channel, and alleviates pain:

Indications – for both Liver and Stomach channel disorders from cold or phlegm, epigastric and abdominal pain, cold hernial pain, menstrual pain, and vertex or migraine headache.

- Epigastric or abdominal cramp with cold and dampness: + Gang Jiang, Mu Xiang, Gui Zhi
- Hernial disorder due to cold obstructing Liver: + Wu Yao, Xiao Hui Xiang
- Headache, vomiting, or excessive saliva with cold sensation due to Liver qi rebellion with middle jiao deficiency cold: + Ren Sheng, Sheng Jiang (wu zhu yu tang)
- Chronic diarrhea due to Spleen and Kidney deficiency: + Bu Gu Zhi, Rou Dou Kou, Wu Wei Zi (si shen wan)

Actions: Redirects rebellious qi downward and stops vomiting:

Indications – for flank pain, regurgitation of sour fluid, a wiry, rapid pulse, and a red tongue due to Liver and/or Stomach disharmony.

- Wu Zhu Yu is one of the most effective herbs to treat vomiting and acid reflux caused by the Liver overacting on the Stomach.
- Acid reflux after meals due to deficiency cold in the Stomach: + *Wu Zhu Yu with Gan Jiang*
- Nausea, vomiting, stomach pain with acid regurgitation due to deficiency and cold of the Stomach: + *Sheng Jiang, Ban Xia, Gao Liang Jiang, Huo Xiang, Sha Ren*
- Acid reflux, stomach pain, hypochondriac pain with foul breath due to Liver heat overacting on the Stomach: + *Wu Zhu Yu, Huang Liang* (Formula: Zuo Jin Wan)
- Huang Lian should be five times greater than that of Wu Zhu Yu.

Actions: Warms the Spleen, stops diarrhea, expels and dries cold-damp

Indications – for diarrhea due to cold from Spleen and Kidney deficiency and damp-cold leg qi. *Bu Gu Zhi, Rou Dou Kou (Formula: Si shen wan)*

Actions: Topical use for leading fire downward

Indication: for sores of the mouth and tongue. The herbs need to be ground into a powder, mixed with vinegar, and placed on the center of the soles of the feet.

Main Actions

- Warms the middle, disperses cold, and alleviates pain
- Redirects rebellious qi downward
- Smooths the Liver
- Dries dampness

Dosage: 1.5 to 5 grams.

Cautions:

Wu Zhu Yu is contraindicated in cases of yin deficiency with heat.

It is not recommended for long-term use or for use in large doses, due to its toxicity.

Overdosage:

Overdose of *Wu Zhu Yu* is characterized by severe abdominal pain, diarrhea, visual disturbance, hair loss, chest oppression, headache, dizziness, and rashes.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of *Wu Zhu Yu*
- Herb for hernial pain
- Herbs for vertex or migraine headache
- How does this herb treat nausea?
- Herbs for treating cold Stomach or Liver fire leading to nausea and acid reflux.
- Herbs for treating diarrhea due to Xu cold.
- Cautions when using *Wu Zhu Yu*

Huā Jiāo 花椒
“flower pepper”

Pericarpium Zanthoxyli Bungeani

English: fruit of Szechuan pepper

Properties: acrid, **hot**, slightly toxic

Channels: Kidney, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle burner, disperses cold and alleviates pain

Indications – deficiency cold in the Spleen and Stomach leading to vomiting, abdominal pain and diarrhea. *Ren Shen, Gan Jiang (da jian zhong tang)*

- Coldness and pain in the epigastric and abdominal regions: dry fry Hua Jiao and apply it to the affected area to disperse cold.
- Diarrhea due more to **cold** than to dampness: use this herb with Fu Zi and Gan Jiang.
- Diarrhea due more to dampness than to cold: combine it with Cang Zhu and Hou Po.

Actions: Kills parasites and alleviates abdominal pain

Indications – used as an auxiliary herb for abdominal pain due to roundworms.

Wu Mei, Gan Jiang, Huang Lian (wu mei wan)

Main Actions

- Warms the middle jiao, alleviates pain
- Kills parasites.

Dosage: 2-5 grams. It may be used both internally and topically.

Cautions: *Hua Jiao* is contraindicated in conditions of excess fire or yin deficiency; use with caution during pregnancy.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Hua Jiao.
- What are the properties of Hua Jiao?
- Herbs for treating deficiency cold in the Spleen and Stomach, leading to vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea.

Bì Bā 荜 菱

Fructus Piperis Longi

English: long pepper fruit

Properties: acrid, hot

Channels: Stomach, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle burner, disperses cold from the Stomach and Intestines, and alleviates pain:

Indications – for cold in the Spleen and Stomach with such symptoms as nausea, vomiting, belching, diarrhea, and abdominal pain

Alleviates toothache by topical use

Main Actions:

Warms the interior and alleviates pain

Dosage: 2-5 grams. It is used both internally and topically.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Bi Ba
- Herbs for treating cold Stomach leading to nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea
- What herbs are used for a toothache?

Dīng Xiāng 丁香
“t-shaped aroma”

Flos Caryophylli

English: clove flower bud

Properties: acrid, warm

Channels: Kidney, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle burner and directs rebellious qi downward

Indications – for cold in the Spleen and Stomach with vomiting, hiccough, abdominal pain, and diarrhea. + Ren Shen, Sheng Jiang, Bai Zhu, Sha Ren

Actions: Warms the Kidneys and aids the Yang

Indications – for impotence or clear vaginal discharge due to Kidney yang deficiency. + *Fu Zi, Rou Gui, Ba Ji*

Main Actions:

- Warms the middle jiao and directs rebellious qi downward.
- Warms and assists Kidney yang.

Dosage: 2-5 grams.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Ding Xiang
- Herbs for warming up the middle burner and directing rebellious qi downward
- What herbs warm and assist Kidney yang?

Gāo Liáng Jiāng 高良姜

- *Rhizoma Alpiniae Officinari*
- **English:** lesser galangal rhizome
- **Properties:** acrid, hot
- **Channels:** Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle Jiao and alleviates pain

Indications – for epigastric and abdominal pain, vomiting, hiccough, or diarrhea due to cold in the middle Jiao.

- Epigastric, hypochondriac, abdominal, and intercostal pain due to qi stagnation (liver, middle jiao). *Xiao Hui Xiang* combines with *Gang Jiang*, *Mu Xiang*, and *Chuan Lian Zi*
- Indigestion, fullness after meals, lack of appetite, and nausea. + *Shen Qu*, *Mai Ya*, *Sha Ren*

Xiǎo Huí Xiāng 小茴香

- *Fructus Foeniculi Vulgaris*
- **English:** fennel seed, fennel fruit
- **Properties:** acrid, **hot**
- **Channels:** Liver, Kidney, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Spreads the Liver qi, warms the Kidneys, expels cold, and alleviates pain.

Indications – used to warm and encourage movement in the Liver channel or the lower burner, as in cold hernial disorders or any kind of lower abdominal pain due to cold. *Wu Zhu Yu*, *Rou Gui*

- Abdominal pain, hernial pain, prolapse sensations in the abdomen, and testicular swelling and pain: *Xiao Hui Xiang* **dispels cold from the Liver and kidney channels.**
- Cold hernial disorder: + *Wu Zhu Yu*, *Rou Gui*, *Chen Xiang*
- Heat-related hernial disorders: + *Chuan Lian Zi*, *Zhi*, *Zi*, *Huang Qin*
- Low back pain caused by Kidney deficiency: + *Du Zhong*, *Xu Duan*, *Bu Gu Zhi*

Actions: Regulates the qi, harmonizes the Stomach, and improves appetite

Indications – qi stagnation in the middle jiao or cold in the Stomach with such symptoms as abdominal pain, indigestion, reduced appetite, and vomiting.

- Epigastric, hypochondriac, abdominal, and intercostal pain due to qi stagnation (liver, middle jiao)
- *Xiao Hui Xiang* combines with *Gang Jiang*, *Mu Xiang*, and *Chuan Lian Zi*
- Indigestion, fullness after meals, lack of appetite, and nausea: + *Shen Qu*, *Mai Ya*, *Sha Ren*

Main Actions:

- Disperses cold, and relieves pain
- Regulates qi (liver and Stomach) and harmonizes the Stomach

Dosage: 3-8 grams.

NOTE: Unprocessed *Xiao Hui Xiang* has the strongest function to regulate qi. The salt-fried herb has moderate acrid and dispersing effects. Salt-frying also enhances

its warming effect on the Kidney and Liver, treating disorders of the lower jiao, such as hernial pain.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Xiao Hui Xiang
- Herbs for treating hernial disorder or testicle pain
- Herbs for treating cold Stomach leading to vomiting, abdominal pain, and distention.

Hú Jiāo 胡椒 “barbarian pepper”

- *Fructus Piperis Nigri*
- **English:** pepper
- **Properties:** acrid, hot
- **Channels:** Stomach, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the middle jiao and alleviates pain

Indications – for cold in the Stomach and intestines with such symptoms as vomiting, diarrhea, and abdominal pain. *Gao Liang Jiang, Bi Ba*

Main Actions: warms the middle and relieves pain

Dosage: 2-4 grams in decoction and 0.5-1 gram in powder.

Cautions:

Hu Jiao is contraindicated in patients with yin deficiency or heat.

Review question

- Actions and indications of Hu Jiao
- Herbs warm the middle jiao

Xì Xīn 细辛 “thin acrid” “fine-pungent”

- *Herba cum Radice Asari*
- **English:** Chinese wild ginger, asarum
- **Properties:** acrid, warm
- **Channels:** Lung, Kidney

Actions and Indications

Actions: Releases the exterior, disperses wind-cold, and alleviates pain

Indications – for any exterior cold pattern, especially with headache, Bi syndrome, and toothache.

- Headache due to wind-cold (migraines): *Chuan Xiong, Bai Zhi, Qiang Huo*
- Toothache: *Xi Xin* can be used alone or with *Bai Zhi*. Make tea and rinse the mouth.
- Toothache due to Stomach heat: *Shi Gao, Zhi Mu, Huang Qin*
- Bi syndrome: *Qiang Huo, Du Huo, Fang Feng*

Actions: Warms the Lungs and transforms Tan Yin (phlegm)

Indications – for patterns of wind cold with congested fluids, manifesting as cough and copious, watery sputum. *Ma Huang, Gan Jiang, Wu Wei Zi*

Actions: Disperses and unblocks the qi of the nasal orifices

Indications – for various types of nasal congestion. + *Bai Zhi, Xin Yi Hua, Cang Er Zi*

Main Actions

- Releases exterior, disperses wind-cold, and alleviates pain
- Warms the Lung and transforms phlegm
- Unblocks nasal orifices.

Dosage: 1-3 grams.

Xi Xin should never be prescribed in excess of the recommended dosage.

Cautions:

Xi Xin is extremely hazardous when used in quantities larger than recommended or when used in powder form.

Xi Xin is contraindicated in patients with febrile disorders, yin deficiency, yang excess, cough or wheezing due to yin deficiency, headache due to blood deficiency or wind-heat, and perspiration from qi deficiency.

Xi Xin is incompatible with *Li Lu*.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of *Xi Xin*
- What herbs can be used for cold congested fluids in the Lung?
- What herbs are used for sinus congestion?
- What herbs are used for toothache due to Stomach heat?
- What is the correct dosage for *Xi Xin*?
- Cautions when using *Xi Xin*

Overdose

Adverse reactions associated with an overdose of Xi Xin are generally observed 1-2 hours after ingestion, but may occur within 30 minutes. The symptoms include headache, increased pressure sensations in the head, nausea, vomiting, perspiration, thirst, red face, restlessness, anxiety, stiff neck, dilated pupils, hurried respiration rate, elevated body temperature, and blood pressure, and a forceful, rapid pulse. In severe cases, anuria, unconsciousness, and respiratory depression.